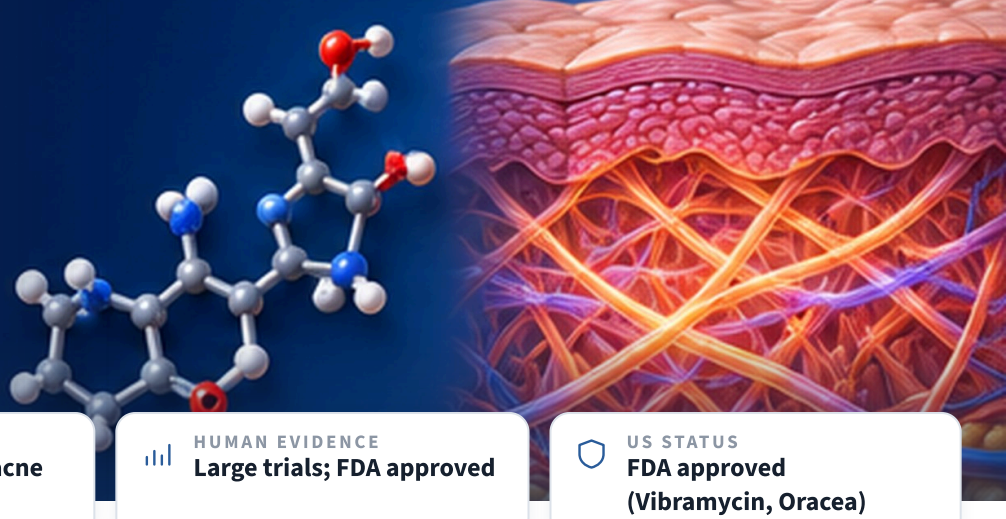
SKIN 04

Doxycycline

Tetracycline-class antibiotic taken by mouth; a low-strength 40 mg form is used for rosacea



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Tetracycline antibiotic	Infections, rosacea, acne	Large trials; FDA approved	FDA approved (Vibramycin, Oracea)

STUDIED FOR

Bacterial infections	Rosacea	Acne
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Acne wording is add-on use. The standard label says doxycycline may be useful adjunctive therapy in severe acne, not a stand-alone acne approval.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Doxycycline → 30S ribosome → Protein synthesis → Bacteria stopped

- **Inhibits bacterial protein synthesis** by binding the 30S ribosomal subunit
- **Bacteriostatic** against a broad range of bacteria, per the label
- **In rosacea,** Oracea's mechanism is unknown, per its label

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Vibramycin approved 1967; Oracea 2006
- Oracea: 2 rosacea RCTs, 537 people, 16 weeks
- Acne: placebo RCT in 51 adults (2003)

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Mechanism in rosacea
- Oracea for infections

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
18 to 22 hours (standard); 21.2 hours (Oracea, single dose)	By mouth (capsules, tablets); also IV
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Peak at 2 hours (200 mg); excreted unchanged in urine, feces	Prescription capsules and tablets (Vibramycin, Oracea, generics)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Sun sensitivity, headache or vision (intracranial pressure)	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved antibiotic (1967); Oracea, rosacea (2006)
DEA	Not a controlled substance
EMA	Authorised nationally in all 27 EU countries
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Doxycycline hyclate capsules prescribing information (DailyMed), Oct 2025
2. FDA, Oracea prescribing information (DailyMed), Apr 2025
3. Skidmore et al., Arch Dermatol, low-dose doxycycline in acne, Apr 2003

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

adonismenshealth.com